RSS Digest
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1. Chirp Pong
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-15T19:47:52+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/15/chirp-pong/
Tool: Chirp Pong Another game experiment - I wanted to see if it was feasible to have a two player game on two separate phones running in static HTML where the networking code uses chirps sent via the microphone. It seems to work! Build a two player competitive pong like game where two players use their phones close to each other and the game state is sent via audio noises which the web microphone API can interpret - but add graphical and gameplay twists to make it a lot more fun and intertwine than pong Claude Opus 5.5 Extra in Claude Code . Tags: game-design , ai , generative-ai , llms , claude-code

2. Anthropic tells investors quarterly revenue up nearly 50% to $16.8bn ahead of IPO
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-15T13:04:03+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/15/anthropic-tells-investors/
Anthropic tells investors quarterly revenue up nearly 50% to $16.8bn ahead of IPO The phrase "told investors" appears four times in this FT article, which reports on Anthropic’s day of hosting investors on Wednesday. Lots of details in here from " people with knowledge of the matter ". Key things I learned from the article: Q1 revenue (Jan/Feb/Mar) was "about $4.8bn" Q2 (Apr/May/Jun) was $11.5bn Q3 (Jul/Aug/Sep) was $16.8bn In Q3: $1.70 in revenue for every $1 spent on "computing power" Adjusted operating margins (excluding stock-based compensation) were 11% This point about distillation is worth quoting in full (highlight mine): The start-up has also clamped down on ?distillation? ? a controversial practice whereby rival AI labs train their models on the outputs of more advanced ones. When rival companies ?distil? their models from Anthropic?s models, that involves heavy usage and spending. Anthropic told investors on Wednesday distillation accounted for 5 per cent to 7 per cent of revenue and that they had cut it back ?materially? in the third quarter of the year, said four people with direct knowledge of the matter. Napkin maths says that if distillation was 5% of their Q2 reve...

3. llm-meta-ai 0.2
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-12T23:58:46+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/12/llm-meta-ai/
Release: llm-meta-ai 0.2 Meta AI release Muse Wonder (and Muse Wonder Full), their new "most capable models". These look like they may be Meta’s first Fable class models - Artificial Analysis scores Muse Wonder (Max) as equivalent to GPT-6.1 Sol. I updated my llm-meta-ai plugin for the new model. Here are pelicans for Muse Wonder for the six reasoning levels: minimal, low, medium, high, xhigh, max. This is the max one: For comparison, here are pelicans for Muse 1.3 (released September 2nd) and Muse 1.2 (released August 5th). Meta AI are putting out a new model a month, and the improvements between each model (at least in terms of drawing pelicans) are material. Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , meta , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , llm-release

4. ? Initial Thoughts on This Week?s New Apple TV 4K (4th Generation) and HomePod Mini 2
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-16T01:18:29Z
Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/10/thoughts_on_new_apple_tv_4k_and_homepod_mini_2
At the old pre-June prices, you could buy a 128 GB Apple TV and a pair of HomePod Minis for $350 ($150 + $100 + $100). Four short months later, with today?s new models, that combination would cost $600 ($300 + $150 + $150).

5. Secret Documents Reveal Donors Behind $330 Million for Trump?s Ballroom ? Apple and Nvidia Top the List at $25 Million Each
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-15T16:11:12Z
Link: https://www.washingtonpost.com/investigations/2026/10/15/secret-documents-reveal-donors-behind-330-million-trumps-ballroom/

Jonathan O?Connell, Sarah Blaskey, and Aaron Schaffer, reporting for The Washington Post (News+ link ; Archive.today link): A list obtained by The Washington Post reveals all the major donors to President Donald Trump?s White House ballroom project, including previously undisclosed contributors who have benefited from regulatory decisions, government contracts and, in one case, a pardon for a family member. Tech giants Nvidia and Apple each committed $25 million, the top contribution amount, the list shows. The Adelson family, one of the GOP?s largest donor dynasties, committed that sum as well, as did billionaire Charles Ergen, co-founder and chairman of telecommunications company Dish Network. Absent from the list is Trump himself, who has said that he is helping to pay for the project. ?It?s being paid for a hundred percent by me and some friends of mine,? he said last year, days after demolition began on the old East Wing. The White House publicly identified 37 people, companies and foundations as donors last October, without revealing the amount of their individual gifts. The list obtained by The Post, an internal spreadsheet used to track contributions for the fundraising...

6. C++ futures part 4: What if I want an immediate on-thread std::async?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 15 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261015-00/?p=112776/
Providing the case that the C++ language won’t do. The post C++ futures part 4: What if I want an immediate on-thread std::async ? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

7. C++ futures part 3: The mental model for std::async
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 14 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261014-00/?p=112774/
Doing things later in different ways. The post C++ futures part 3: The mental model for std::async appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. This video is 2 minutes long
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 16 Oct 2026 05:28:42 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/byte-size/two-minutes-long-video
As I mentioned before, it takes me way too long to edit a single video . So I am releasing it in chunks. If I never finish it, well then at least I’ll have a few videos out. What is the video about? Well, it is about the future we were promised, versus the one we are actually living in. It’s not dystopian, but it seems like the goal of tech is supposedly to automate the tedious and mundane, so we can have more time to do the things we love. But along the way came the word productivity. The goal of productivity is not to get free time. It is to produce more in the same amount of time. Not produce more in less time. Read this a couple times for it to stick. Click the image to load The first one was 1 minute long . Today’s will be two minutes . And the next will be 3 minutes long. Then I’ll have to think about Fibonacci.

9. Pluralistic: Expedia amazoned hotel rooms (15 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 15 Oct 2026 11:03:29 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/15/enshittipedia/
Today’s links Expedia amazoned hotel rooms: Everything more expensive for everyone, monopolies everywhere, and we’re all screwed. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Delta v dovening; "Play Money"; Alabama’s ethnic cleansing; We trust neuroscience over psychology; Billionaires’ anti-homeless pogrom; Game devs v DRM; What security means; Microsoft, tear down that wall! Publisher won’t revert rights; SNL’s Trump/Clinton debate; Chicago Tribune’s murder; AI after AI. Upcoming appearances: Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Vienna, Kilkenny, Oxford, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Expedia amazoned hotel rooms (permalink) No matter where you shop, you’re getting screwed by Amazon. Amazon has found a way to make

everything you buy ? at Target, at a mom-and-pop shop, even direct from the manufacturer ? more expensive. And they’re not the only one: Expedia’s done the same thing, but for hotel rooms. Here’s how Amazon broke the economy: first, they locked in a key group of shoppers. The vast majority...

10. How to Train Your Robot
Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 15 Oct 2026 14:23:58 GMT
Link: https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-to-train-your-robot
The enormous advance in AI capabilities over the last several years has in large part been driven by the availability of vast amounts of training data.

11. We Need All the Disciplines
Source: Jim Nielsen?s Blog | Published: Thu, 15 Oct 2026 19:00:00 GMT
Link: https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/we-need-all-disciplines/
From where I sit, figuring out what to build, building it, and shipping it are all part of the art of making software. Many disciplines have emerged through the years to facilitate this work: product, design, engineering, devops, etc. We need all these disciplines to make great, dependable software (granted, in different doses). Each brings different values and judgments; each sees things the others don?t. And including all might mean going a bit slower. Human collaboration may seem less ?efficient? than handing the work over entirely to the machines. But inefficiency may be the cost of collaborating with humans, rather than extracting an output from a machine. We gain not only from their judgment and expertise in a particular discipline, but from the relationship, trust, and shared understanding that blossoms from making something together. As the old proverb says: ?If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together.? Reformulated for today: If you want to go fast, go with the LLM. If you want to go far, go with your fellow humans. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky